Ke Cheng HSU (Clio) 許可證

khsu@connect.ust.hk

https://cliohsu1997.github.io/

BUSINESS ADDRESS

Department of Economics, 5067 Lee Shau Kee Business Building
The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Clear Water Bay, Kowloon, Hong Kong

RESEARCH FIELDS

Industrial Organization, Digital Economics, Quantitative Marketing

EDUCATION

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Ph.D. in Economics	2022 – 2027 (expected)
M.Phil. in Economics	2020 – 2022
B.Sc. in Mathematics and Economics (Minor in Actuarial Mathematics)	2015 – 2019

WORKING PAPERS

- "Designing Return Policy in E-Commerce: A Trade-off between Purchase and Return Efficiency" *(Job Market Paper)*

  Abstract: We study the effect of return policies by asking whether they encourage efficient returns and purchases. A stricter return policy curbs inefficient ex-post returns, but the resulting lower return rates make higher product prices more attractive for sellers, leading to possible exclusion of ex-ante efficient purchases. We compare automatic coverage that reimburses return-shipping costs (RI) with optional coverage (CI) by estimating a structural model of purchase, insurance, and return decisions under monopoly pricing across six apparel categories. A lenient return policy like RI performs better in high-margin, high-salvage categories by expanding valuable purchases, whereas a strict return policy like CI performs better in thinner-margin categories by curbing excessive returns. Partial RPD, a menu pairing a discounted price with a medium restocking fee as penalty, performs better than RI and CI for most categories by better balancing purchase and return efficiency.

  Presented at (for scheduled):* APIOC 2026*; 2026 Econometric Society Australasia Meeting (ESAM 2026)*; 中國經濟學年會夏季論壇 2026*; HKUST Business School PhD Conference; CEP Brownbag in HKUST.

- "Product Design with Heterogeneous Search Costs", with Pak Hung AU

  Abstract: Building on Wolinsky's (1986) sequential search model with differentiated products, this paper

introduces search cost heterogeneity to analyze how firms leverage observable product designs to influence consumer search behavior. In equilibrium, consumers' search patterns form a partitioned structure: those with low search costs tend to seek niche products, while consumers facing higher search costs gravitate toward standardized products. In the case of two product designs, a reduction in search costs may lead to higher prices for both if the endogenous shift in consumer search modes—the composition effect—dominates the search-encouraging effect. Additionally, we demonstrate that prices respond asymmetrically to decreases in search costs based on the relative position within the distribution where the shock occurs.

Presented at: APIOC 2023; AMES 2023 NTU Singapore.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Pass-Through and Incidence with Product Returns", with Ce Bian and Liang Zhao

  Abstract: We study pass-through and incidence with product returns. In contrast to the case without returns, a tax such as a platform commission fee or a sales tax can create negative pass-through and improve social welfare. When a high price significantly raises consumers' return probability, the seller reduces the quantity supplied because of a lower effective margin. This downward-sloping supply curve can lower the equilibrium price in response to a tax increase, raising social surplus by reducing the return rate.

- "Too Much Unsold Stock?: Environmental Consequences of Price Commitment", with Kohei Kawaguchi and Kei Kawai

  Abstract: Resale price maintenance is procompetitive because it encourages sellers to carry inventory in the low-demand state. When realized demand falls short of that inventory, however, the seller cannot lower the price to clear the market, and the unsold copies are returned at an environmental cost. We build a dynamic oligopoly model with demand uncertainty, estimate it on monthly bookstore data, and ask how much unsold stock is due to price commitment and how a deposit-refund tax can reduce waste.

EXPERIENCE

Research

Research Assistant for Prof. Benjamin Bernard, National Taiwan University 2020

Conducted simulations and wrote proofs for a financial-network model of a bank crisis on an interbank lending network; modeled crisis intervention as a negotiation between the regulator and the banks' creditors and studied when a no-bailout threat is credible.

Teaching

Lecturer, Math Camp for MSc in Economics, HKUST (4.53/5) 2026

Teaching Assistant Coordinator, Business School, HKUST 2025 – 2026

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, HKUST (average 4.72/5) 2020 – 2025

ECON2123 – Macroeconomics (4.53/5)

ECON4134 – Economics of Uncertainty and Information (4.83/5)

ECON4999T – Economics of Uncertainty and Information (4.56/5)
ECON5210 – Microeconomic Theory I (4.85/5; 4.82/5)

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Research Travel Grant	2023; 2026
Red Bird PhD Award	2022
Postgraduate Studentship from the HKUST	2020 – present
Academic Achievement Medal	2019
University Scholarship (730K HKD)	2015 – 2019

SKILLS

Technical Skills: R, Python, C++, LaTeX, MATLAB, AWS
Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native), Cantonese (basic)

REFERENCES (THESIS SUPERVISION COMMITTEE)

Pak Hung AU
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
aupakhung@ust.hk

Kohei Kawaguchi
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
kkawaguchi@ust.hk

Kei Kawai
Professor
Department of Economics
University of Tokyo
kawaixkei@gmail.com

許可證（Ke Cheng HSU, Clio）

khsu@connect.ust.hk
https://cliohsu1997.github.io/

通讯地址
香港九龙清水湾香港科技大学李兆基商学大楼 5067 室
经济系

研究方向
产业组织、数字经济、量化营销

教育背景

香港科技大学

经济学博士	2022 – 2027（预计）
经济学哲学硕士（M.Phil.）	2020 – 2022
数学与经济学理学学士（副修精算数学）	2015 – 2019

工作论文

- 《电商退货政策设计：购买效率与退货效率的权衡》（Designing Return Policy in E-Commerce: A Trade-off between Purchase and Return Efficiency）（求职论文）

  摘要：本文研究退货政策是否同时促进有效退货与有效购买。更严格的退货政策可以抑制事后无效退货，但退货率下降会使卖家更倾向于提高价格，从而可能把事前有效的购买排除在外。我们在六个服装品类、垄断定价下估计购买、运费险与退货决策的结构模型，比较自动报销退货运费的保障（RI）与可选保障（CI）。宽松政策（如 RI）在高毛利、高残值品类中表现更好，因为它扩大了有价值的购买；严格政策（如 CI）在毛利较薄的品类中表现更好，因为它抑制过多退货。部分退货罚金（Partial RPD）——将折扣价与中等程度补货费配对的菜单——在多数品类中比 RI 和 CI 更好地平衡购买效率与退货效率。

  报告（* 为已安排）： APIOC 2026*；2026 Econometric Society Australasia Meeting（ESAM 2026）*；中国经济学年会夏季论坛 2026*；香港科技大学商学院博士生会议；香港科技大学 CEP Brownbag。

- 《异质搜寻成本下的产品设计》（Product Design with Heterogeneous Search Costs），与 Pak Hung Au

  摘要：在 Wolinsky（1986）差异化产品序贯搜寻模型的基础上，本文引入搜寻成本异质性，分析企业如何利用可观察的产品设计影响消费者的搜寻行为。均衡中，消费者的搜寻呈现分割结构：搜寻成本较低者倾向于寻找利基产品，搜寻成本较高者倾向于标准化产品。在两种产品设计下，若搜寻模式的内生转变（构成效应）主导了鼓励搜寻的效应，搜寻成本下降可能使两种产品的价格同时上升。此外，价格对搜寻成本下降的反应取决于冲击落在成本分布中的位置，因而并不对称。

  报告： APIOC 2023；AMES 2023，新加坡南洋理工大学。

进行中的研究

- 《含退货的价格转嫁与税负归宿》(Pass-Through and Incidence with Product Returns)，与 Ce Bian、Liang Zhao

  摘要：本文研究存在产品退货时的价格转嫁与税负归宿。与无退货情形不同，平台佣金或销售税可以产生负向转嫁并提高社会福利。当高价格显著提高消费者的退货概率时，有效利润率下降，卖家减少供给。这条向下倾斜的供给曲线可以使均衡价格随税收上升而下降，并通过降低退货率提高社会剩余。

- 《滞销过多？价格承诺的环境后果》(Too Much Unsold Stock?: Environmental Consequences of Price Commitment)，与 Kohei Kawaguchi、Kei Kawai

  摘要：转售价格维持具有促进竞争的作用，因为它鼓励卖家在低需求状态下持有库存。但当实现需求低于库存时，卖家不能降价出清，未售出的商品被退回并带来环境成本。我们构建含需求不确定性的动态寡头模型，用月度书店数据估计，并考察有多少滞销来自价格承诺，以及押金—退款税如何减少浪费。

经历

研究

研究助理，Benjamin Bernard 教授，台湾大学 2020

针对银行间借贷网络上的银行危机模型进行模拟并撰写证明；将危机干预建模为监管机构与债权人之间的谈判，研究无救助威胁何时可信。

教学

讲师，经济学硕士数学营，香港科技大学（4.53/5） 2026

教学助理协调员，商学院，香港科技大学 2025 – 2026

教学助理，经济系，香港科技大学（平均 4.72/5） 2020 – 2025

ECON2123 宏观经济学（4.53/5）
ECON4134 不确定性与信息经济学（4.83/5）
ECON4999T 不确定性与信息经济学（4.56/5）
ECON5210 微观经济理论 I（4.85/5；4.82/5）

奖助

研究差旅资助 2023；2026

Red Bird 博士奖 2022

香港科技大学研究生助学金 2020 – 至今

学术成就奖章 2019

大学奖学金（73 万港元） 2015 – 2019

技能

技术：R、Python、C++、LaTeX、MATLAB、AWS
语言：英语（流利）、普通话（母语）、粤语（基础）

推荐人（论文指导委员会）

Pak Hung Au
副教授
经济系
香港科技大学
aupakhung@ust.hk

Kohei Kawaguchi
副教授
经济系
香港科技大学
kkawaguchi@ust.hk

Kei Kawai
教授
经济系
东京大学
kawaixkei@gmail.com

☐ ☐ *(02/2020)*

香 港 中 文 大 学（深圳）
THE CHINESE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG, SHENZHEN
职位申请表
APPLICATION FORM

注：Note:

申请人所提供的资料将用作招聘或其他与雇佣有关事宜，并会供大学有关部门、委员会或其他处理招聘事宜的人士查阅。招聘程序完成后，未获取录的应征者資料，当无需保留时将全部销毁。

The information provided will be used for appointment and other employment-related purposes in the University. It may be accessible to offices, committees or persons who will process appointment matters. Information on unsuccessful candidates will be destroyed after the recruitment exercise when no longer required.

申请职位 Post Applied for Post Doctoral Fellow - Shen Rui Project, School of Management and Economics (博士后 - 经管学院申睿项目; Ref. PR2026/035/01)

I. 个人资料 Personal Particulars

英文姓名（姓氏先行） Name in full (English) (Surname first) Hsu, Ke Cheng		中文姓名 Name (Chinese) 許可證	* 称谓 / Title Mr. / 先生
国籍 Nationality China (Taiwan)	户口所在地 City of Residency Taipei, Taiwan, China	出生日期 Date of Birth 12 May 1997	# 护照号码 / 身份证号码 Passport No. / I.D. Card No. 353355701
通讯地址 Correspondence Address Department of Economics, 5067 Lee Shau Kee Business Building, The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Clear Water Bay, Kowloon, Hong Kong			
住址（如与上址不同） Residential Address (if different from above)			
电话号码 Telephone No. Mobile: (852) 6840 9753			电子邮址 E-mail Address khsu@connect.ust.hk
必要时通知 姓名 及 关系 Emergency Contact (Name & Relationship) Xu Jiayi (friend)	必要时通知 电话 及地址 Emergency Contact number & address (852) 9295 0662 香港 上環畢街 15 號 6 樓		

II. 学历 / 学术荣誉 / 奖状 (请顺序列出) Academic Qualifications / Awards / Distinctions (in chronological order)

由 From 月 / 年 Month / Year	至 To 月 / 年 Month / Year	教育机构 / 院校名称 (请列明所在国家) Institution of Learning / College / University Attended (Please specify country)	所获学历 Qualifications / Awards / Distinctions Obtained	主修科目 / 范畴 Major Subject / Field of Study
09/2015	12/2019	The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Hong Kong)	B.Sc.	Mathematics and Economics (Minor: Actuarial Mathematics)
08/2020	08/2022	The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Hong Kong)	M.Phil.	Economics
08/2022	06/2027 (expected)	The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Hong Kong)	Ph.D. (in progress)	Economics (IO, Digital Economics, Quantitative Marketing)

III. 工作经验（请顺序列出）Working Experience (in chronological order)

由 From 月 / 年 Month / Year	至 To 月 / 年 Month / Year	工作机构及地址 Name and Address of Employer	职位 Appointment Held (如属兼职，请予注明) (if part-time, please specify)	工作性质 Nature of Work
01/2020	07/2020	National Taiwan University Taipei, Taiwan	Research Assistant (for Prof. Benjamin Bernard)	Conducted simulations and wrote proofs for a financial-network model of a bank crisis on an interbank lending network.
08/2020	Present	Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Clear Water Bay, Hong Kong	Teaching Assistant / TA Coordinator / Lecturer (Math Camp)	TA for undergrad/grad economics (macroeconomics, information economics, microeconomic theory); TA Coordinator, Business School; Math Camp lecturer

* 请于适当空格加✓号 Please tick as appropriate # 请删去不适用者 Please delete as appropriate

IV. 专业资格 (请顺序列出) Professional Qualifications / Memberships (in chronological order)

专业团体 (全名) Professional Body (Full Name)	所获专业资格 Qualification / Membership Obtained	获取途径 (如考试、推选等) Channel of Award (e.g. exam., election)	颁发日期 Date of Award
N/A			

V. 曾担任之研究工作/出版著作 (教学/研究员申请人适用) Major Research/ Published Work (For Teaching & Research Posts only) 请连同著作撮要一并交回 Please attach abstracts of publications if available.

期间 Period	名称及性质 Name / Nature of The Work	备注 Remarks
Working paper / JMP	Designing Return Policy in E-Commerce: A Trade-off between Purchase and Return Efficiency	Structural IO / e-commerce / platform design
Working paper	Product Design with Heterogeneous Search Costs (with Pak Hung Au)	Search / product design theory
Work in progress	Too Much Unsold Stock?: Environmental Consequences of Price Commitment (with Kohei Kawaguchi and Kei Kawai)	Dynamic oligopoly
Work in progress	Pass-Through and Incidence with Product Returns (with Ce Bian and Liang Zhao)	Tax incidence under returns

VI. 咨询人 (现时 / 前雇主) Referees (Present / Previous Employers)

姓名 Name	公司名称 / 职衔 Company Name / Position	通讯地址 Correspondence Address	传真号码 / 电子邮址 Fax no. / E-mail Address
1. Pak Hung AU 2. Kohei Kawaguchi 3. Kei Kawai	Associate Professor, Dept. of Economics, HKUST Associate Professor, Dept. of Economics, HKUST Professor, Dept. of Economics, University of Tokyo	HKUST, Clear Water Bay, Kowloon, Hong Kong HKUST, Clear Water Bay, Kowloon, Hong Kong University of Tokyo, Tokyo, Japan	aupakhung@ust.hk kkawaguchi@ust.hk kawaixkei@gmail.com

除非特别注明，大学将毋须再行通知应征者并可径向上述咨询人查询。请先行知会上述咨询人。
Unless otherwise specified, consent is deemed given by the applicant to the University to approach the above referees whenever appropriate without prior notification. Please also inform your referees that such consent has been given by you.

VII. 过往薪酬纪录 Past Salary Record

期间 Period	公司名称 / 职衔 Company Name / Position	每月基本薪酬 Monthly Basic Salary	每月保险及公积金供款 Monthly Insurance and Housing Fund Contribution	其他津贴 Other Allowances
N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

VIII. 其他 Others

1. 现职离职通知期
   Notice Period Required by Present Employer: Not Applicable
2. 如获聘任可到任日期
   Earliest Date Available if Appointed: February 2027
3. 请问从何处得悉本职位空缺？
   How did you learn about this vacant position? CUHK website
   (例：期刊 / 报章名称及日期) (e.g. Name and date of journal / newspaper, etc.)
4. 申请人如有近亲现职于香港中文大学 (深圳)，请列明其姓名、职位及与申请人的关系
   If you have close relatives currently employed by The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, please state their names, posts and relationship to you.

   None
5. 其他与申请此职位有关的资料
   Applicants may use the following space to provide any other relevant information in support of your application.

   Job market Paper Attached

IX. 声明 Declaration

本人谨此声明以上所提供的资料均属真实及所附证明文件皆为真确副本。如获聘任，本人将提供有关身份及资历文件的正本 / 核实真确本予大学作查核。本人明白倘若故意虚报资料或隐瞒重要事实，香港中文大学(深圳) 可取消已发出的口头或书面聘约或纵使已获聘任亦可遭解雇。

I declare that the information given above is correct and complete to the best of my knowledge and that the documents provided by me in connection with this application are true copies. I will produce the original / certified true copies of all identification and qualification documents as required by the University upon assumption of duty at the University if appointed. I understand that if I knowingly supply false information or withhold any material information, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen shall have the right to rescind any verbal / written offer of appointment and I shall render myself liable to dismissal if I am eventually appointed by the University.

日期
Date 2 November 2026

签署
Signature HSU Ke Cheng